

5.4 Bandwidth Monitors

These are informative tools that can track your Net connection's bandwidth usage. This information is useful to ensure that you are getting the speed that has been promised, and whether you are optimally utilising the bandwidth. All monitors usually offer a graphical representation of the data being transferred in both directions.

5.4.1 Netmeter (readerror.gmxhome.de)

Netmeter is an excellent monitor because of its extreme customisability and reporting capabilities. Besides showing a graph of the current downloads and uploads in different colours, it also displays the totals for durations like day, week, and month, even offering an extrapolated estimate for each duration. It can also alert the user if certain user specified transfer limits are crossed.

The graph window itself is completely customisable. The graph colours can be changed, and the window resized and repositioned. On XP, the graph can be made visually transparent. The windows can also be made to allow click through—meaning that items that are overlapped by the Netmeter window can be operated. The graph can be configured to display transfers over a period of time.

5.4.2 Bandwidth Vista

(www.bandwidthvista.com/download.htm)

Another bandwidth monitor worth mentioning. While it remains significantly unwieldy compared to Netmeter, it accomplishes the basic task of displaying bandwidth usage. It brings in an additional feature—geographical mapping. It can identify, on a world map, the locations of the PCs which are connected to the user's PC.



Bandwidth Vista—a must-try